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Transcripción de audio

IELTS Academic · Set 6

01 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 1: Alquiler de una bicicleta

Agent: Hello, Riverside Cycle Hire. What can I do for you?

Customer: Hi, I'd like to rent a bicycle for a few days while I'm visiting.

Agent: No problem at all. Can I start with your name?

Customer: Sure, it's Daniel Fletcher.

Agent: Could you spell the surname?

Customer: Yes, it's F-L-E-T-C-H-E-R.

Agent: Thanks, Mr Fletcher. And the best number to reach you on?

Customer: It's 07531 480926.

Agent: Got it. How long will you need the bike for?

Customer: For three days, please - I'm here until Thursday.

Agent: Before you choose, it may help to think about the routes you expect to use. The riverside path is smooth and fairly level, whereas the tracks beyond the old quarry have loose surfaces and some steep bends. A bicycle suited to paved roads can feel quick in town but less stable once the surface changes.

Customer: I want to explore beyond the town, so stability matters more than speed.

Agent: In that case, we should also check the frame size carefully before you leave. The adjustment is quick and prevents avoidable strain later.

Agent: Fine. And what sort of bike were you after? We do road bikes and mountain bikes.

Customer: I was going to go for a road bike, but actually I'll take a mountain bike - some of the trails here are quite rough.

Customer: Can the saddle and handlebars be adjusted? I have sometimes found hire bicycles uncomfortable after an hour or so.

Agent: Yes. We set both while you are here and ask you to ride around the yard before accepting the bicycle. That short check also gives us time to test the brakes and gears with you. If anything feels awkward, tell us immediately; it is much easier to correct the fit here than halfway along a trail.

Agent: Good choice for the trails. Now, we do ask for a deposit. Will you be paying by cash or card?

Customer: By card, if that's alright.

Agent: Of course. Would you like any extras? A lot of people hire a helmet.

Customer: Yes, I'll definitely take a helmet - safety first.

Agent: Sensible. And don't worry about breakdowns: a repair kit is included free with every rental.

Agent: We provide a strong lock as part of the rental, and we recommend securing the frame to a fixed stand whenever you stop. The agreement covers ordinary mechanical faults, but it does not cover a bicycle left unsecured or damage caused by using a route that is closed to cyclists.

Customer: I have downloaded the council's route map, so I can check the permitted tracks.

Agent: Good. Temporary closures are marked there each evening.

Customer: That's reassuring. Where do I bring the bike back?

Agent: We have two branches, but hired bikes must be returned to the central branch, near the market square.

Customer: What should I do if the weather becomes too poor to ride safely?

Agent: Telephone us rather than attempting an unsafe journey. We can advise you about secure storage or arrange collection, and we can usually pause the hire when an official warning closes the trails. Ordinary rain does not qualify, though wet conditions are a good reason to reduce your speed and allow a longer braking distance.

Customer: That seems reasonable. I will keep the contact number with me.

Customer: Central branch, noted. Could you run through the prices?

Agent: Certainly. A mountain bike is five pounds an hour, or eighteen pounds for a full day. The deposit on that one is thirty pounds, and it comes with lights fitted.

Customer: And the electric bikes?

Agent: An electric bike is nine pounds an hour, or thirty-five pounds a day, with a fifty-pound deposit. Each electric bike also comes with its own charger.

Agent: When the rental ends, a member of staff will inspect the tyres, brakes and lock with you. Normal wear is expected, so a little mud is not a problem, but please mention any fall or mechanical difficulty even if the bicycle still seems usable. That information lets our workshop examine the relevant component before the next rider sets off.

Customer: Fine. I would rather report a small concern than leave it for somebody else to discover.

Customer: Perfect. I'll take the mountain bike for three days.

Agent: Wonderful, let me sort that out for you.

02 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 2: Recorrido por un nuevo centro recreativo

Good afternoon, everybody, and welcome to the grand opening of the Oakhill Leisure Centre. My name's Priya, and I'll be showing you round our new building this afternoon. It has taken nearly two years to build, and I think you'll agree it's been well worth the wait. Let me begin with what's actually new here, because there's been some confusion. The swimming pool, although it looks brand new, was in fact refurbished from the old centre, and the café has simply been expanded. The sports hall is the same one many of you will remember. What is genuinely new are two things we're very proud of: a full climbing wall, the tallest in the region, and a Finnish-style sauna next to the changing rooms. Those two are completely new additions. Before we begin walking round, let me explain how the building is organised.

The entrance level is intended for quick visits and enquiries, while the exercise areas are grouped beyond the reception gates. Clear sightlines were a priority in the design, so staff can direct visitors without creating a queue across the foyer. If this is your first visit, allow a few minutes to learn the route before an activity begins. This helps everyone start calmly and move safely. Now, some useful information. On weekdays the centre opens at seven in the morning, which is early enough for a swim before work. Do note that it closes early on Sundays, at four rather than the usual ten, so plan your weekend visits accordingly. Access has been planned for people with different mobility needs. A lift reaches every public floor, and adjustable equipment is available in the fitness room.

Anyone who would like help adapting an exercise can speak privately to an instructor before taking part. The aim is to make an appropriate adjustment, rather than assuming that everybody needs the same pace or range of movement. Let's talk membership. A standard membership costs forty pounds per month, which gives you unlimited access to all the facilities. As a welcome offer, every new member also gets a free session with a personal trainer to set up a fitness plan. The changing areas use separate dry and wet routes. If you are heading towards the pool, follow the blue floor markings so outdoor footwear does not cross the clean area. Visitors going to an upstairs activity should use the corridor beside reception.

Please keep emergency exits clear, even when the building is quiet, and tell a staff member if you notice water on a walkway. A few notes on the facilities themselves. The pool has a special shallow area for toddlers, so it's ideal for families with young children. One small practical point: the lockers require a pound coin, which you get back at the end, so do keep one handy. Our programme changes during school holidays, when demand is different from the normal weekly pattern. The current timetable is displayed at reception and online, and any late alteration is posted in both places. Reserving a place is advisable for activities with fixed equipment, but the open fitness areas can usually be used without advance notice. Staff can explain which arrangement applies before you make a journey.

Finally, our timetable of classes is packed. We offer everything from spinning to boxing, but by far the most popular class is yoga - the morning sessions fill up within minutes, so do get here early if you'd like a space on the floor. To secure a place, all booking is done through the centre's website, so please create an account before you leave today. Before we set off, one practical point concerns

conduct in shared spaces. Please return small equipment to its marked rack, wipe down anything you have used and keep personal calls outside the exercise rooms. Photography is restricted because other visitors may not wish to appear in an image. These rules make busy periods more comfortable and allow instructors to concentrate on safe movement instead of repeatedly reorganising the room.

Right, if you'd like to follow me, we'll start with the climbing wall. Please stay together as we go.

03 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 3: Conversación sobre un trabajo de marketing

Tutor: Come in, Sophie, Mark. Let's go over your marketing coursework. Remind me what the main focus is.

Sophie: Well, at first we thought about comparing two rival brands, and we also considered designing a brand-new product. But in the end we decided to analyse a real marketing campaign - the "Go Green" campaign from last year.

Tutor: A sensible choice, and there's plenty to say about it. Sophie, why did you pick that clothing company in particular?

Sophie: Honestly, it's not because they're especially famous, though they are. The real reason is that they've published a lot of their sales data, so I actually have the figures to work with.

Mark: We have permission to discuss the campaign material, but should we remove the respondents' names from our working file as well as from the final submission?

Tutor: Yes. Replace each name with an anonymous code before you begin comparing responses. Keep the consent records separately, with access limited to the group. Ethical handling is part of the method, even when the topic itself seems harmless.

Sophie: I will make that change before we analyse anything further.

Tutor: That's exactly the right thinking - data makes all the difference. Real figures are always far more convincing to an examiner than personal opinions. Now, I've read your draft. The introduction is strong, and your word count is fine. What really needs work is your survey questions - several of them are quite leading.

Sophie: Some replies use different words for what seems to be the same idea. Should we combine them immediately?

Tutor: First write a precise rule for each category, then test it on a small group of replies. If you combine entries simply because they sound similar, you may hide a useful distinction. Ask Mark to apply the rule independently and compare your decisions.

Mark: That should show us where the definition is too vague.

Mark: We wondered about that. We also weren't happy with the survey itself.

Tutor: In what way?

Mark: The main issue was that we simply didn't get enough responses - only about thirty people replied, so it's hard to draw firm conclusions.

Tutor: Yes, thirty is too few. Try sharing it more widely this time. And how are you planning to present your findings?

Mark: We also have a few incomplete replies. I was tempted to remove them all so the totals would be tidy.

Tutor: Do not make that decision for appearance's sake. Record how much information is missing and whether it affects the comparison you plan to make. You may exclude a response when the required measure cannot be calculated, but state the rule consistently and report how many records it affects.

Sophie: So the cleaning process needs an audit trail as well.

Tutor: Exactly. Keep that record, and then return to the practical question of how you will show the findings.

Sophie: We thought about making a short video, but we've settled on a set of slides - it feels more professional for this kind of report.

Sophie: When we discuss the results, how do we stop the strongest pattern from sounding more certain than it is?

Tutor: Link every claim to the way the evidence was collected. You can describe what occurred among your respondents, then explain the limit on applying it to a wider population. A cautious interpretation is still valuable if the reasoning is clear.

Mark: We will keep observation and interpretation in separate paragraphs, then check that the conclusion answers the original question.

Tutor: Rehearse the handover between the methods and findings sections as well. The audience should understand why each measure is being shown before it sees the result.

Sophie: We can ask another student to listen without seeing our notes and tell us where the argument becomes difficult to follow.

Tutor: Exactly. Use that feedback to repair the link, rather than adding more material automatically. Clarity usually comes from selecting and ordering evidence well.

Tutor: Slides work well. Right, a few final reminders before you submit. Add a clear label to each chart, otherwise the reader gets lost. Make sure you reference all sources correctly, including websites. Keep the tone formal throughout - no slang. Proofread carefully for spelling, because errors cost marks. And when you're done, upload the file as a PDF, not a Word document. Do all of that, and you'll be in a strong position for a good mark.

Mark: Got it. Thanks very much.

04 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 4: La historia del té

Good morning. Today's lecture traces the long and fascinating history of tea, a drink now enjoyed by billions of people every day. Let's begin at the very start. Tea was first drunk in China thousands of years ago, and Chinese legend credits its discovery to an emperor whose boiling water was flavoured by falling leaves. Interestingly, tea was not originally a social drink at all - it was taken as a medicine, valued for keeping people alert and aiding digestion. In those early days, the drink was made simply from dried leaves steeped in hot water, much as it is today. To understand why tea travelled so successfully, we should consider its practical qualities as well as its taste. Once processed and kept dry, it could survive a long journey better than many fresh products.

A small quantity produced many servings, which made storage and transport economical. Its preparation also required heated water, a habit that could reduce some risks associated with unsafe supplies, even though people at the time did not understand the microbiology involved. From China, tea gradually spread across Asia. It was carried to Japan by monks, who had studied in Chinese monasteries and brought the custom home with them. There, tea became far more than a beverage: an elaborate and highly formal tea ceremony developed, with strict rules governing every movement. Processing methods created considerable variety from the same basic crop. Producers could alter oxidation, drying and roasting to obtain different aromas and colours.

These techniques were shaped by local climate and custom, then adjusted again when merchants wanted a product that would remain consistent during transport. The names used in commerce did not always describe the process accurately, so historians compare business records with surviving equipment and accounts of manufacture. Now, how did tea reach the West? It was first shipped to Europe by Portuguese traders in the sixteenth century, though the Dutch and later the British soon dominated the trade. Tea quickly became fashionable, but it was expensive, and for many years Europeans paid for their tea with silver, which drained their treasuries and caused serious tension with China. Demand also influenced public life.

Specialist rooms became places where news, business and political ideas circulated, while domestic tea drinking developed its own conventions. Access was never uniform: price, taxation and social rules determined who could participate and where. When duties became especially high, smuggling expanded and legal sellers pressed for reform. Changes in tax could therefore reshape consumption more quickly than a change in taste. This brings us to mass production. To reduce their dependence on China, the British set up enormous plantations in India, particularly in the region of Assam. This made tea far cheaper and turned it into an everyday drink. However, we should not romanticise this period - conditions were often extremely hard for the workers, who laboured long hours for very little pay.

The familiar story of a single accidental invention often simplifies a longer development. Containers, serving vessels and heating equipment changed repeatedly as manufacturers responded to different homes and workplaces. An innovation succeeded when it fitted existing routines, could be produced reliably and offered a clear convenience. Less practical designs disappeared from everyday use, although catalogues and advertisements show that inventors explored far more

alternatives than the surviving objects suggest. Finally, a word about convenience. For centuries tea was brewed loose in a pot, but in the early nineteen-hundreds the tea bag was invented, apparently by accident, when a merchant sent out samples in small silk pouches.

This simple innovation made tea quicker and cleaner to prepare, and it transformed how the world drinks tea. Modern research has returned to questions that earlier drinkers approached through experience. Studies compare brewing temperature, time and particle size because each affects which compounds enter the drink. Stronger colour does not always mean a greater concentration of every component, and results from one preparation method cannot automatically be applied to another. This is why scientific accounts specify both the material tested and the way the drink was prepared. Next week, we'll look at the science of how tea affects the body. Thank you.